

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a newspaper article about a 'dinosaur hunter':

China's dinosaur hunter

Xu Xing is the go-to man in China for anything people want to know about dinosaurs. He has an extraordinary track record and has named 60 species so far – more than any other researcher in his field. And he is only 43 years old.

Xu didn't set out to be a dinosaur hunter; in fact, he had no idea what a dinosaur was until he entered university. Initially, Xu wanted to study economics, but in those days, students were not allowed to choose their degree. For reasons that are unclear to him, he was assigned 'Palaeontology', the study of fossils.

While he was working on his master's degree, the small number of dinosaur species which were being discovered in China grew rapidly. Funding was increasing; farmers started recognising the value of the fossils they found; and construction meant that new fossils were being unearthed more frequently.

Fossils are now a thriving business as well as a science in China. Dinosaur hunters often have to have good relationships with farmers, museum directors and the tourism bureau to gain access to fossil sites. One of Xu's concerns is the fossil 'grey market', where people try and sell fake bones or buy real ones and keep them in their private collection.

Xu says, 'When I started my career, I never expected that I would have made so many discoveries. It's a job that requires a lot of hard work and luck.'

Dr. Xu Xing is visiting your school to talk about his work on dinosaurs. Your group is preparing for his visit. You may want to talk about:

- aspects of his life and career people would be interested in
- questions to ask Dr. Xu
- any other activities that can be included in Dr. Xu's visit
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Are you interested in dinosaurs?
2. Do you think dinosaurs are scary?
3. Would you go to a dinosaur exhibition?
4. What would your friends and family say if you wanted to become a dinosaur hunter?
5. Would you be interested in going on a field trip to look for fossils?
6. What is the attraction of studying dinosaurs?
7. Is the study of dinosaurs important?
8. If dinosaurs could be cloned, would you support it?